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Analyst for ESD's Collection Services
Division: Mohamad Alsheikh Yassin.
Unofficially, Mohamad is on PandA's short
list of most interesting City employees.
Read on to learn why!

During the three years he's been part of the City team, no two of Mohamad's days have been exactly the same. Generally, his workday starts with checking in on data - making sure GIS layers and systems are in sync and reviewing any issues that might have popped up overnight. Then, Mohamad will spend some time writing Python scripts (this is sort of like coding but to automate a data workflow), editing spatial data in ArcGIS Pro, or building out a dashboard or mapping product for a special project.



The best part of Mohamad's job? It's the moment when something he built actually changes how someone works. It could be a dashboard that helps a supervisor see route performance in a way they never could before or a script that automates something that used to take hours of manual work for multiple team members. He loves technical problem-solving, but what really motivates him is knowing that the data and tools he produces help people make better decisions...and ultimately helps the City serve residents more effectively.

We asked Mohamad why data is important to use in his job, and you have to hear his answer: "Because the alternative is guessing. When you're managing an operation serving 225,000+ households with about 1 million assets, 700+ routes, and 250+ vehicles, you need evidence behind every decision. Data shows you where the real problems are, whether your changes are working, and how to build trust with leadership and the public." YES. THIS. ALL OF THIS!

When he isn't in front of a computer, Mohamad likes to balance his screen time with time spent outdoors or working with his hands (on something that isn't a keyboard). In the summer, he volunteers as a Firelookout with the Forest Service, scanning for smoke from a historic tower above the backcountry. In the winter, he heads out to the Borrego desert with the State Parks archaeologist, surveying ancient and historic sites and protecting cultural resources as an archaeology technician. Mohamad also enjoys baking, gardening, and woodworking when he's home. So, yeah, a very interesting guy - and a teammate we're all lucky to have at the City!